

UX RESEARCH · PERSONA · PROTOTYPE

# LoanEase

## Simplifying Digital Loan Applications

A user-centred design case study covering research, personas, journey mapping, interaction design, and a high-fidelity Figma prototype.

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G-21 · Team Submission

### Team

Sri Krishna Prabhu · Singh Aditya Randhir · Sindhu B · Sirumulla Sneha

WHAT WE'LL COVER

# Agenda



## Problem Statement & Research

Method, participant profile, key insights

01



## Personas & Journey Map

Two user segments and a key-task journey

02



## Interaction Design

Two core interaction models

03



## Prototype & Figma Link

Screens across the loan application flow

04



## Recommendations & Team

Priority roadmap and contribution summary

05

PROJECT AT A GLANCE

42

Survey responses

12

User interviews

2

Personas built

9

Prototype screens

## PROBLEM STATEMENT

# Why LoanEase?

**A financial institution is launching LoanEase — a platform that helps users apply for loans and track their application status.**

The goal is to design a user-centred experience that simplifies complex financial processes and improves transparency throughout the loan journey — from checking eligibility to receiving funds.

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### OUR ROLE

As the Design Team, we own the full experience — research, persona definition, journey mapping, interaction design, and a high-fidelity clickable prototype covering at least three core features.



### Simplify

Reduce complexity in a traditionally paper-heavy, jargon-filled process



### Increase Transparency

Keep users informed at every stage — fees, timelines, status



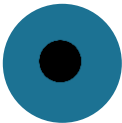
### Build Trust

Give users confidence to share sensitive financial documents

USER RESEARCH SUMMARY

# A Mixed-Method Research Approach

Quantitative and qualitative methods were combined to understand behaviour, motivations, and pain points across the digital loan journey.



42

Online Survey

responses collected — 41 valid after consent screening



12

Semi-structured Interviews

participants across 10+ occupations, thematically analysed



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Observation

not conducted — excluded for privacy & ethics around financial data

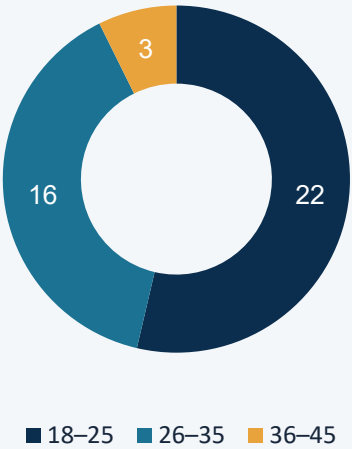


Research activities completed: literature review, survey design & fielding, 12 interviews, quantitative and thematic qualitative analysis, and a full findings & handover report.

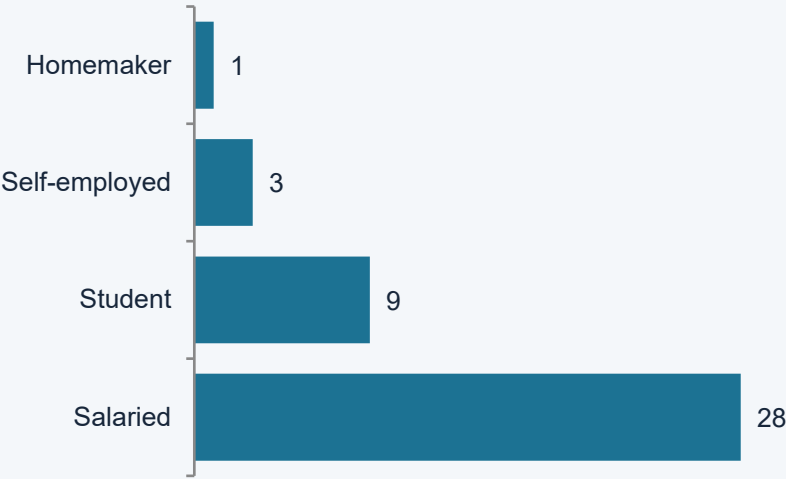
RESEARCH FINDINGS

# Who We Heard From & What We Learned

AGE DISTRIBUTION (n=41)



OCCUPATION (n=41)



**46%** have applied for a loan before

**88%** would adopt a well-designed digital platform (36/41)

**68%** call approval waiting the hardest stage (8/12 top issue)

KEY INSIGHT

Respondents are mostly young, digitally active salaried employees and students (18–35) — a mix of first-time and returning borrowers — giving a balanced view of both new and experienced applicants.

RESEARCH FINDINGS

# Pain Points in the Loan Journey



Survey (n=41) — top challenges selected by participants

VOICE OF THE USER

*“I don't mind waiting a day or two, but don't leave me guessing in the dark about where my application is stuck.”*

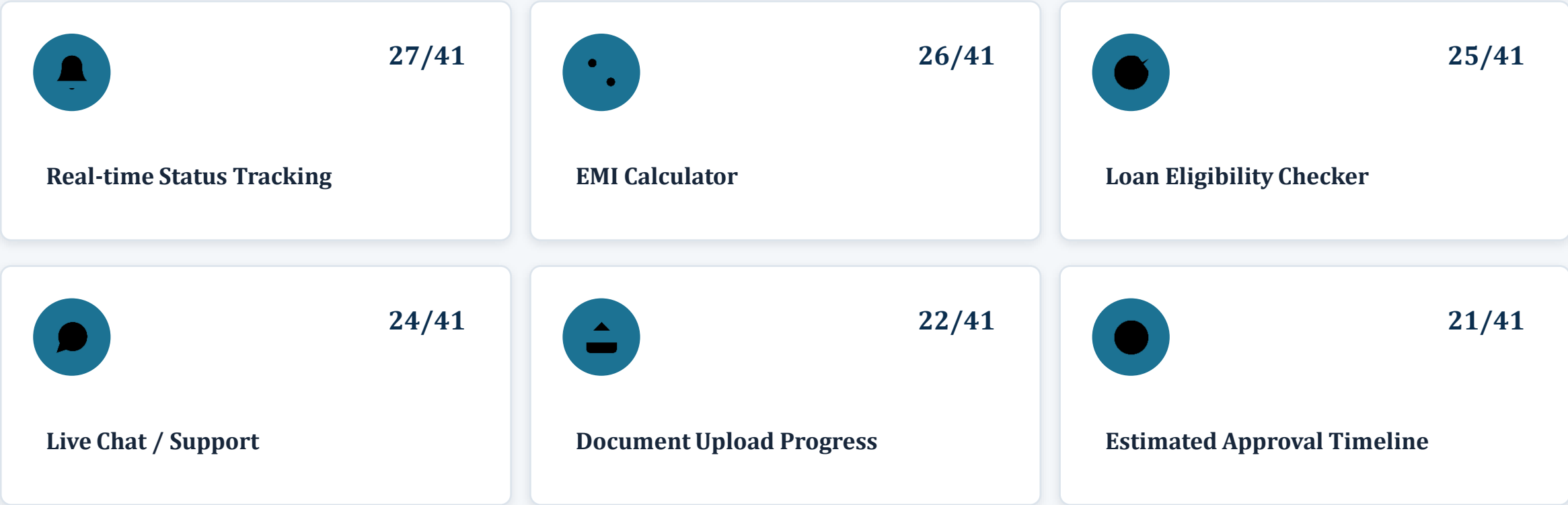
*“I want to know exactly what I'll pay every month and whether I qualify before I upload my documents.”*



Waiting for approval was named the single hardest stage in both the survey and 12 interviews — the #1 priority for redesign.

RESEARCH FINDINGS

# Feature Expectations & User Needs



26/41 participants rated real-time updates “Extremely Important” — transparency is a core expectation, not a nice-to-have.

PERSONA 1 OF 2

# Ananya Singh — The First-Time Applicant

AS

Ananya Singh

Junior Software Developer  
Mumbai, India

AGE

23

LOAN NEEDED

Personal / Education Top-Up

LOAN EXPERIENCE

None (first-time)

GOALS & MOTIVATIONS

- Understand eligibility without damaging her credit score
- Calculate exact monthly repayments before committing
- Get plain-language clarity on rates, fees & foreclosure terms

PAIN POINTS & FRUSTRATIONS

- Confused by jargon like amortisation & processing fees
- Hesitant to upload documents without safety indicators
- Fears rejection midway due to missed eligibility rules

“I want to know exactly what I’ll pay every month and whether I qualify before I upload my documents.”

KEY FEATURE NEEDS (MAPPED TO RESEARCH)

Loan Eligibility Checker — instant income/age feedback

EMI Calculator — visualise payments across tenures

Plain-language tooltips for every fee



PERSONA 2 OF 2

# Priyanshu Sharma — The Time-Sensitive Professional

PS

Priyanshu Sharma

Senior Marketing Manager  
Delhi, India

AGE

30

LOAN NEEDED

Personal / Home Renovation

LOAN EXPERIENCE

Yes — returning borrower

GOALS & MOTIVATIONS

- Fast, transparent processing without endless follow-ups
- Real-time, step-by-step application status updates
- A one-time, streamlined document submission workflow

PAIN POINTS & FRUSTRATIONS

- “Black-hole” waiting periods with zero status updates
- Annoyed by repeated requests for the same documents
- No live assistance when a status update stalls

*“I don't mind waiting a day or two, but don't leave me guessing in the dark about where my application is stuck.”*

KEY FEATURE NEEDS (MAPPED TO RESEARCH)

Real-time Status Tracker — visual pipeline & ETA

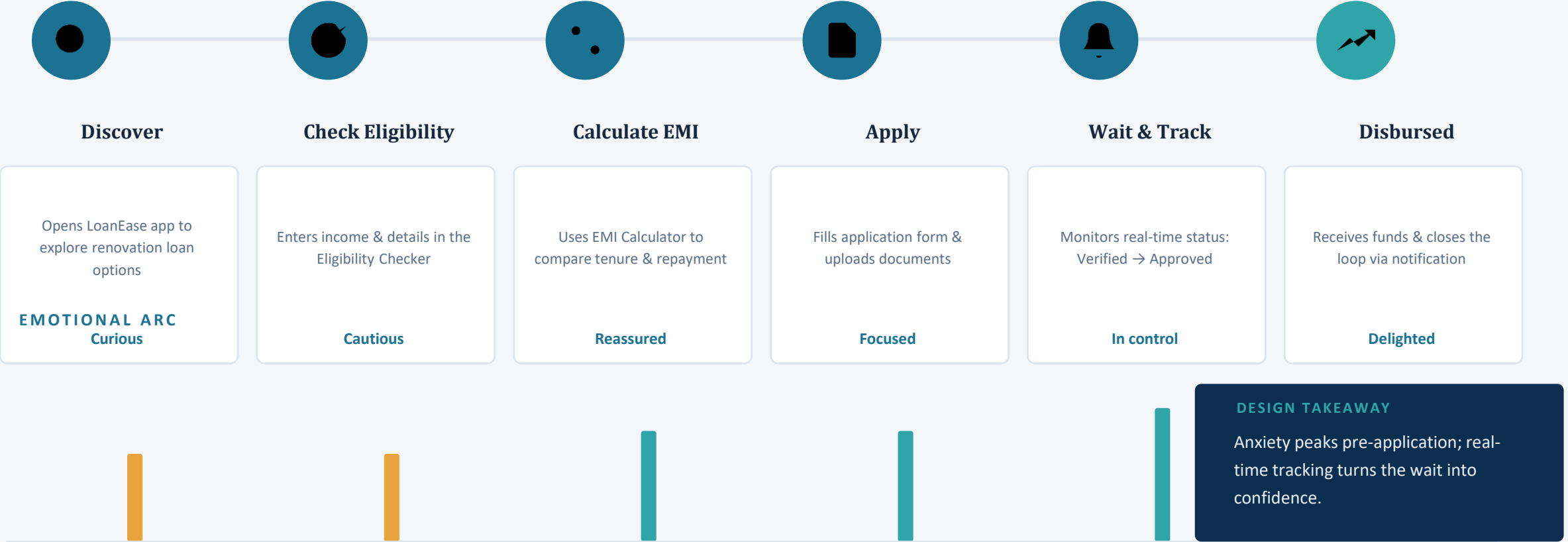
Smart Document Upload — checklist & verification

In-app Live Chat for stuck applications

USER JOURNEY MAP

# Priyanshu's Journey — Applying for a Personal Loan

Key task: check eligibility, calculate EMI, apply, and track the application to disbursal



## INTERACTION DESIGN · 1 OF 2

# Form-Based Interaction

· Structured input flows for tasks that require accuracy and guided completion



Users complete structured forms while checking eligibility, calculating EMI, entering personal details, uploading documents, and submitting applications.

Input fields, progress indicators, and guided workflows help users complete tasks efficiently while reducing errors.

*Why it was chosen: addresses research pain points around eligibility confusion and document handling.*

### KEY FEATURES



**Eligibility Checker**



**EMI Calculator**



**Loan Application Form**



**Document Upload Workflow**



**Review & Submit Process**

## INTERACTION DESIGN · 2 OF 2

# Direct Manipulation Interaction

· Immediate, tactile feedback that builds transparency and confidence



Users directly interact with dashboard cards, buttons, progress indicators, tracking timelines, and support features.

Immediate visual feedback provides transparency and helps users understand the current status of their application at a glance.

*Why it was chosen: directly answers the #1 research pain point — lack of transparency and status visibility.*

### KEY FEATURES



**Dashboard Navigation Cards**



**Application Status Tracking**



**Progress Indicators**



**Interactive Buttons**

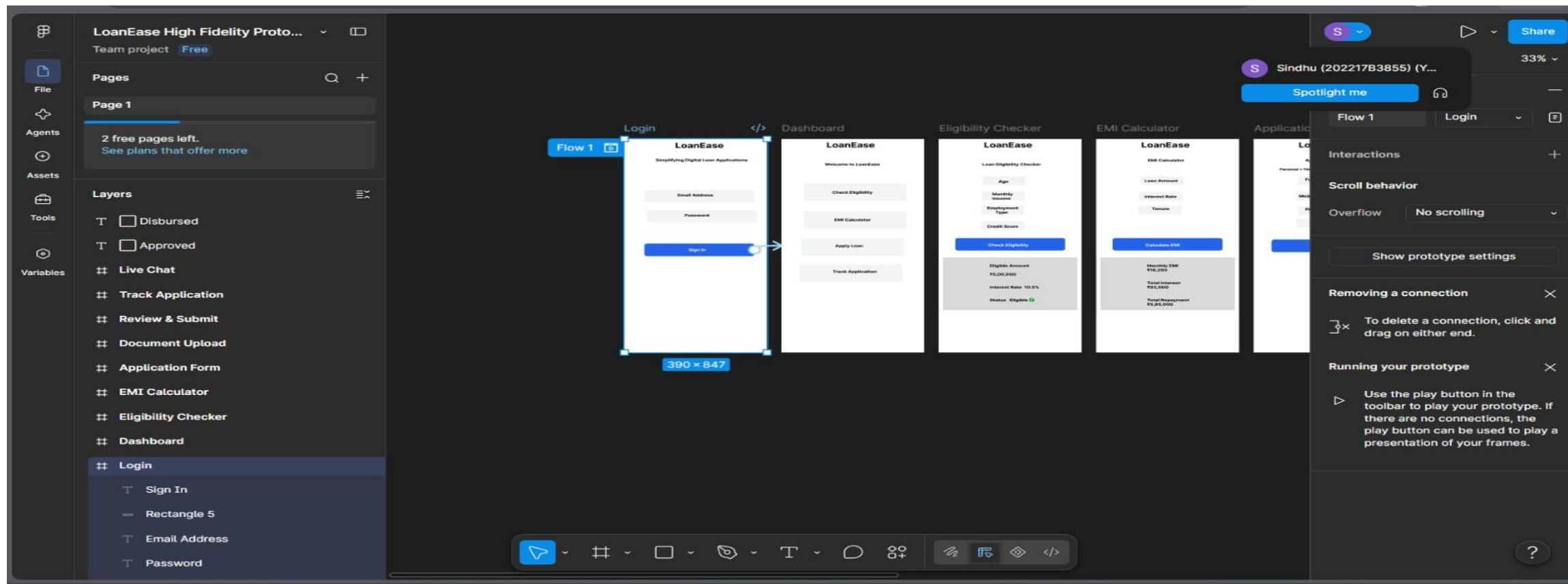


**Customer Support Chat**

## HIGH-FIDELITY PROTOTYPE

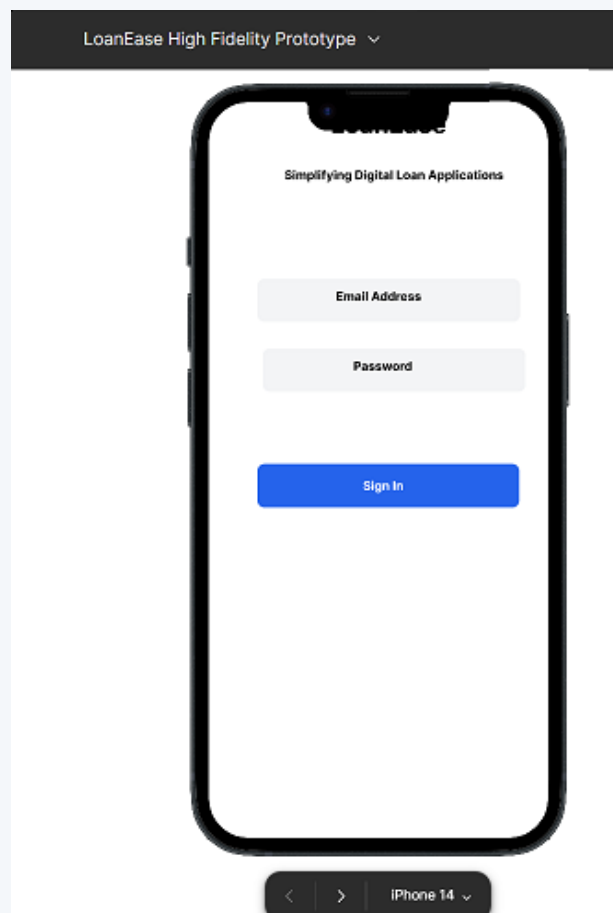
# End-to-End Application Flow

Designed in Figma · 9 connected screens covering login through post-disbursal support



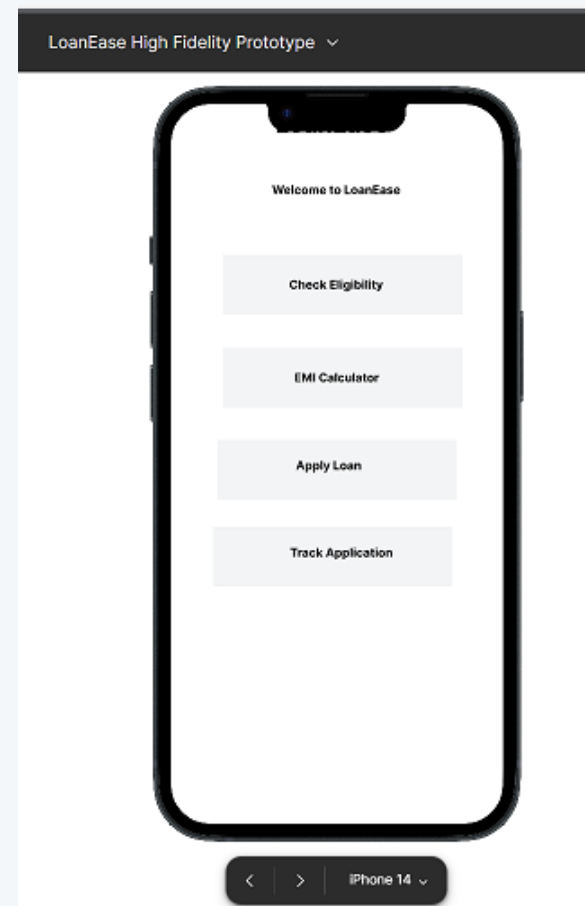
PROTOTYPE SCREENS • 1 OF 4

# Login & Dashboard



Login

Simple, secure sign-in with email and password — sets a trustworthy first impression.



Dashboard

A clear entry point to the four core journeys: Check Eligibility, EMI Calculator, Apply Loan, and Track Application.

# Eligibility Checker & EMI Calculator

Form-based interaction — directly addresses the #2 research pain point: understanding eligibility

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Loan Eligibility Checker

Age

Monthly Income

Employment Type

Credit Score

Check Eligibility

Eligible Amount

₹5,00,000

Interest Rate 10.5%

Status Eligible ✓

Eligibility Checker

Users enter age, income, employment type and credit score to get an instant Eligible Amount, interest rate, and status — before committing to a full application.

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EMI Calculator

Loan Amount

Interest Rate

Tenure

Calculate EMI

Monthly EMI

₹16,250

Total Interest

₹85,000

Total Repayment

₹5,85,000

EMI Calculator

Adjustable loan amount, interest rate and tenure produce a live monthly EMI, total interest and total repayment breakdown.

# Application Form & Document Upload

Guided, multi-step flow — reduces the document-handling frustration surfaced in interviews

### Application Form

A tabbed Personal → Financial → Documents → Review flow keeps a long form from feeling overwhelming.

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### Apply for Loan

Personal > Financial > Documents > Review

Full Name

Mobile Number

PAN Number

Address

Next

### Document Upload

A checklist (Aadhaar, PAN, Salary Slip) with a live completion bar gives constant visibility into what's left to submit.

## LoanEase

### Upload Documents

Personal > Financial > Documents > Review

✓ Aadhaar Card

✓ PAN Card

📎 Salary Slip

80% Completed

Continue



# Review, Track & Support

Direct-manipulation interaction — answers the #1 research pain point: transparency after submission

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Review Application

Review & Submit

A transparent summary — loan amount, rate, processing fee, EMI — with explicit “No Hidden Charges” confirmation before submission.

Loan Amount  
₹5,00,000

Interest Rate  
10.5%

Processing Fee  
₹2,000

Monthly EMI  
₹16,250

✓ No Hidden Charges

✓ Transparent Fee Breakdown

Submit Application

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Track Application

A step tracker (Submitted → Verified → Approved → Disbursed) with estimated timeline and last-updated timestamp.

Application Status

✓ Submitted

✓ Documents Verified

Under Review

Approved

Disbursed

Estimated Approval

2 Days

Last Updated

10:30 AM

Contact Support

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Customer Support

Live Chat

In-app support for stuck applications, closing the loop on the #5 pain point: poor customer support.

Hello! How can I help you?

What is my loan status?

Your application is under review.

Send Message

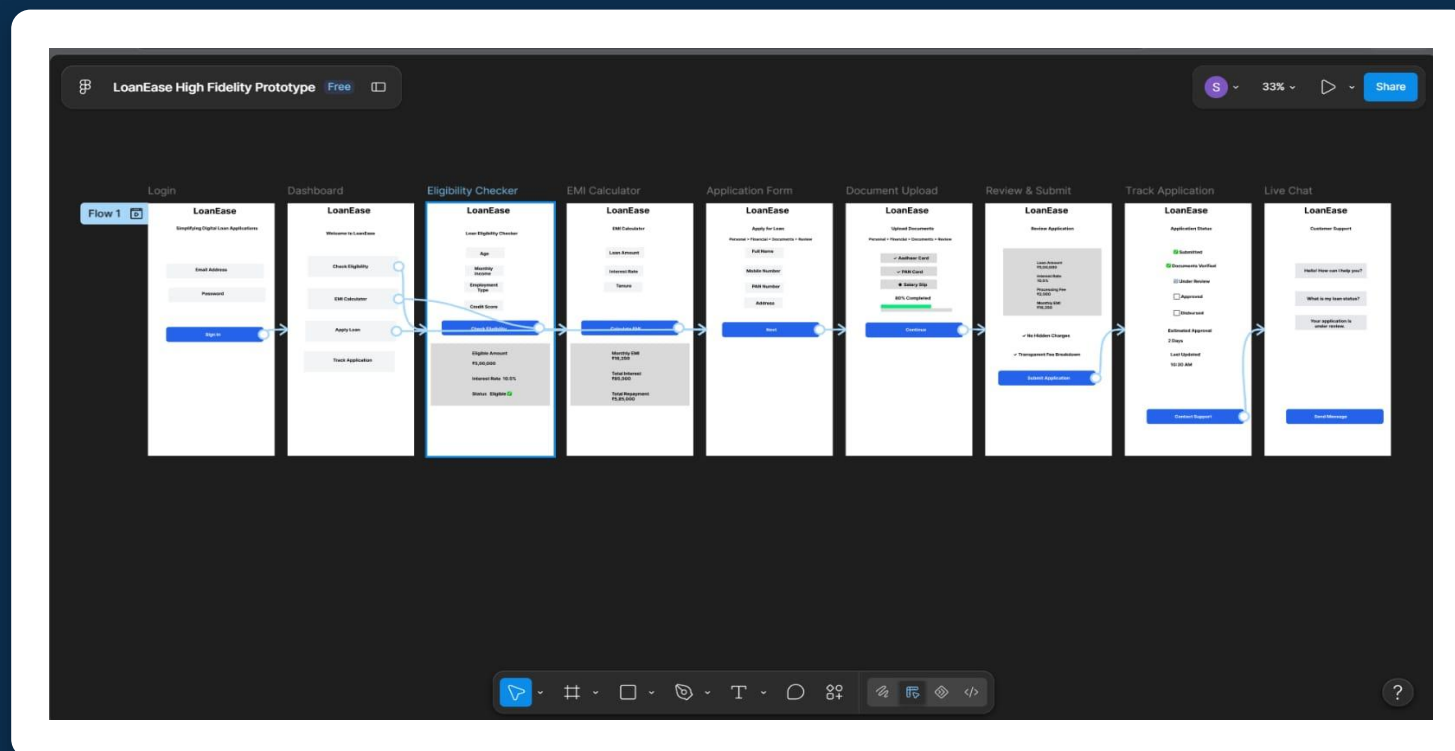
LoanEase

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## INTERACTIVE PROTOTYPE

# View the Live Figma Prototype

Click through the full LoanEase experience — Login, Dashboard, Eligibility, EMI, Application, Documents, Review, Tracking, and Live Chat.



PROTOTYPE LINK

**LoanEase High Fidelity Prototype**

[LoanEase High Fidelity Prototype](#)

[Open Prototype](#) [LoanEase High Fidelity Prototype](#) →

<https://www.figma.com/design/DrpAVCc3n9gPrXHmsw9wXL/LoanEase-High-Fidelity-Prototype?node-id=6-61>

## RECOMMENDATIONS

# Prioritised Design Roadmap

### HIGH PRIORITY



#### Real-time application tracking

Most requested feature — addresses approval uncertainty



#### Loan eligibility checker

Helps users understand requirements before applying



#### EMI calculator

Supports financial planning and informed decisions



#### Document upload progress tracker

Reduces confusion during document submission



#### Estimated approval timeline

Addresses concerns about long waiting periods

### MEDIUM PRIORITY



#### Plain-language explanations

Improves understanding of loan terms and charges



#### Live chat support

Timely assistance during the application process



#### Centralised information hub

Ensures consistent communication across channels



#### Loan comparison feature

Helps users evaluate available loan options

*Rather than resisting digital services, users seek greater confidence and guidance throughout the journey — every recommendation above is traced directly to survey or interview evidence.*

## TEAM CONTRIBUTION

# Who Worked on What

Four equal contributors — each owning one full stage of the LoanEase deliverable

EQUAL CONTRIBUTION · 25%



Person 1 – 202217b3137

**Sri Krishna Prabhu**

Contributed by identifying the problem statement, conducting user research, analyzing user needs and documenting the key findings that formed the foundation of the project.

EQUAL CONTRIBUTION · 25%



Person 2 – 202217b3060

**Singh Aditya Randhir**

Contributed by creating the user personas, empathy map and user journey map ensuring the design process remained user centered and aligned with user requirements.

EQUAL CONTRIBUTION · 25%



Person 3 – 202217b3855

**Sindhu B**

Contributed by designing the Figma prototype, developing wireframes and documenting the interaction design to create an intuitive and user-friendly interface.

EQUAL CONTRIBUTION · 25%



Person 4 – 202217b3794

**Sirumulla Sneha**

Contributed by performing usability evaluation, identifying design improvements, refining the prototype based on feedback,, integrating and conducting the final quality review.

## Thank you

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